

ENG 101
Lesson -25

Examples

(a) *Computer skills are useful in college. They will help you in getting a job as well.*

(b) *Our club raised money for the Red Crescent an organization like this is a wonderful thing.*

(c) *He left early he said he had a toothache.*

Recognizing Fused and Comma Splices

Practice 1. Identify the following sentences as fused (F) or comma splice (CS). Then mark the place between the two complete thoughts with a slash (/). The first two have been done for you.

E.g. (a) The room is locked / no one has a key. F (b) The wall is covered with ivy, / a stone path leads to the wall. CS

1. Raheel likes to cook his wife taught him how. (_____).

2. The bell rang the wrestlers returned to the ring. (_____)

3. The trunk is in the basement it has a handle missing. (_____)

4. The waiters served soft drinks to the children they offered coffee to the adults.
(_____)

5. It rained during our trip to Murree we played cards and told stories. (_____)

Correcting Fused Sentences:

There are 3 ways of correcting a fused sentence.

1. Divide the fused sentence into two sentences.

- *The lake is calm today it looks like a blue mirror. (Wrong Version)*

(Corrected Version)

- *The lake is calm today. It looks like a blue mirror.*

(Corrected Version)

2. Put a comma and an appropriate joining word (such as *and*, *but* or *so*) between the two complete thoughts. *E.g. (I) Computer skills are useful in college they will help you in getting a job as well. (Erroneous version)*

-Computer skills are useful in college, and they will help you in getting a job as well. (Correct version)

(ii) Yousaf Youhanna has a pulled muscle he won't play any cricket this season. (Erroneous version)

-Yousaf Youhanna has a pulled muscle, so he won't play any cricket this season. (Correct version)

NOTE:

The comma always goes before the joining word - not after it.

3. Use subordination to make one of the complete thoughts dependent on the other one. To subordinate a complete thought, change it from a statement that can stand alone as a sentence to one that cannot stand by itself.

To do so, begin the thought with an appropriate word, such as *because*, *when*, *if*, *before*, *since*, *until*, *unless*, *while*, *as*, *though* and *after*.

Example

- Youhanna has a pulled muscle he won't do any batting in this tournament.

-Because Youhanna has a pulled muscle, he won't do any batting in this tournament.

Note:

Put a comma at the end of a dependent word-group that begins a sentence.

The fish was served with its head still on, I lost my appetite.

- Because the fish was served with its head still on , I lost my appetite.

First you should clean the floor, then you should vacuum the carpet.

-First you should clean the floor ,and then you should vacuum the carpet.

Correcting Comma Splice:

A comma splice can be connected by using one of the same three methods suggested for correcting a fused sentence:

1. Divide the comma splice into two sentences:

-Saad is always nervous about tests. His grades are usually the best in the class.

2. Connect the two complete thoughts by placing a joining word (such as *and*, *but* or *so*) after the comma:

-Saad is always nervous about tests, but his grades are usually the best in the class.

3. Use subordination (add a dependent word to one of the complete thoughts):

-Saad is always nervous about tests although his grades are usually the best in the class.

Practice 3 :

Correct each of the comma splices that follow, using one of the methods suggested. Use a different method for each sentences.

1. *Fahd was talking on the phone, he was switching TV channels with his remote control at the same time.*

-Fahd was talking on the phone, and he was switching TV channels with his remote control at the same time.

2. *Mules are very sure-footed, they're used for climbing steep mountains.*

-Mules are very sure-footed , so they're used for climbing steep mountains.

3. *The electricity at the shopping center went out, all the shops had to close early.*

-Since the electricity at the shopping center went out , all the shops had to closed early.

4. *Bicycles are the world's best method of transportation, they don't pollute the atmosphere.*

- Bicycles are the world's best method of transportation, because they don't pollute the atmosphere.

5. *I don't like the Principal's way of expressing herself, I agree with many of her ideas.- **Although** I don't like the Principal's way of expressing herself, I agree with many of her ideas.*

Review of Fused and Comma Splice Constructions

Fill in the missing word in each space.

1. A _____ is made up of two complete thoughts that are incorrectly joined together with nothing between them.
2. A _____ is made up of two complete thoughts that are incorrectly joined together with only a comma between them.
3. One way to correct fused sentences and comma splices is to add a _____ and a capital letter.
4. Two complete thoughts can be joined together in a sentence by a comma and a _____ word such as **and**, **but** or **so**.
5. Two complete thoughts can be joined together in one sentence by adding a _____ word such as **when** or **because**.
6. The fused sentence and the comma splice are also known as _____ sentences.

Test:

Fused & Comma Splices

Rewrite each of the following sentences using the methods suggested.

1. A plane flew very low overhead, the houses rattled loudly.
*-A plane flew very low overhead , **and** the houses rattled loudly.*
2. Garlic may smell bad it tastes delicious. It has other good qualities as well. Garlic can help lower cholesterol it is also supposed to keep away disease.
*- Garlic may smell , **but** it tastes delicious. It has other good qualities as well. Garlic can help lower cholesterol , **and** it is also supposed to keep away disease.*
3. My psychology final exam is next week, I am very worried about passing it. Because I was sick at the start of

the term, I never completed the prescribed reading. For the past month I've been working in the evening, it's hard to find time to study, I will ask the teacher for extra help it may be too late.

A **modifier** is one or more words that describe another word or group of words. In the following examples the modifier is bold faced and the word it modifies is underlined. e.g.

(i) The woman **with gold-rimmed spectacles** is my boss.

The modifier *with gold-rimmed spectacles* describes *woman*.

(ii) My neighbour has a spaniel **with one ear missing**

(iii) I have **nearly** a thousand stamps.

A **misplaced modifier** is a modifier that is incorrectly separated from the word or words that it describes. The misplaced modifier seems to describe words that the writer did not intend it to describe. When modifiers are misplaced, the reader may misunderstand the sentence.

-My brother bought a used car from a local dealer with a leaking pipe.

-The sparrow built a nest at the back of our house of grass and twigs.

-Anjum Nisar almost sneezed twenty times last night.

--My brother bought a used car (with a leaking pipe) from a local dealer.

-The sparrow built a nest (of grass and twigs) at the back of our house.

- Anjum Nisar sneezed (almost) twenty times last night.

PRATICE 1:

Identify the misplaced word(s) in each sentence. Then rewrite the sentence placing the modifier where it will make the meaning clear.

1. I am returning the jacket to the store that is too small.

2. The couple looked at thirty sofas shopping on Saturday.

Single Word Modifiers

NOTE:

Pay special attention to single word modifiers, such as **only**, **almost** and **nearly**. For their meaning to be correctly understood, they should be placed directly in front of the word they describe.

e.g. (i) I only asked my boss for one day's leave, but he refused.

(ii) I must have almost answered a hundred ads before I found this job

(iii). After returning from college my niece nearly spends all evening on the telephone.

Dangling Modifiers e.g.

Staring dreamily into space, the instructor's loud voice startled me.

-Staring dreamily into space, I was started by the instructor's loud voice. OR

-As I was staring dreamily into space, the instructor's loud voice startled me.

Here are more samples of ways by which dangling modifiers can be corrected.

-When pulling out of the driveway, the pillar blocks my view.

-When pulling out of the drive way, **I find** my view blocked by the pillar.

OR – **Whenever I pull out** of the driveway, the pillar blocks my view.

PRACTICE 2. In each sentence identify the misplaced or dangling modifier. Then rewrite each sentence so that its intended meaning is clear.

1. The man returned the overdue book to the librarian with apologies.

2. The soldiers hold up in the caves almost went without food and water for a week.

3. The sky was blue and clear when we arrived home. But only a short while later, with a sudden crash of thunder, we hurried to close the windows in the bedrooms. Staring out at

the downpour, we were glad to be safe inside. Then we remembered our open car windows, groaning with dismay.

4. I lost my raincoat last winter. I thought I'd looked everywhere for it. Then, yesterday, stuffed under the bed, I spotted it. Wrinkled and dusty, I was still delighted to see it.